Akhilesh Agrawal

Senior HR Business Partner / HR Lead

Strategic HR Leadership for Hyper-Growth

A 16+ years Senior HR Leader specializing in building, scaling, and optimizing HR functions within high-growth e-commerce (Bigbasket) and Agri-Tech (DeHaat) environments.

Core Value Proposition:

- **Hyper-Scale Architect:** Built compliant HR structures from scratch and led rapid talent acquisition, successfully onboarding 1000+ personnel in 6 months and scaling regional operations from 0 to 45+ hubs.
- **Strategic Unit Economics:** Delivered direct, measurable business impact by executing strategic manpower restructuring that achieved a 50%+ reduction in per order delivery cost (from Rs. 7.5 to Rs. 3.5 - 4).
- **Talent Transformation:** Expert in Competency Mapping, Career path, and designing performance-based compensation models to maximize productivity and retention in fast-paced operational and technical teams.

Ready to align HR strategy with aggressive business goals.

DGM-HR (Lead HR)

DeHaat (Green Agrevolution Pvt Ltd.) | 09/2021 – 06/2025 | Gurgaon

- **Strategic Policy Development:** Led the review and revamp of core employee policies (Performance Incentive, Transfer, Notice Period & Leave Policy etc.) to improve competitiveness and align with business expansion.
- **HR Technology & Data Foundation:** Guided the implementation of a new HRMS System, which included migrating and cleaning cluttered legacy data to establish reliable, structured HR information and reporting.
- **Performance & Talent Infrastructure:** Introduced a data-driven performance culture by implementing Role-wise KRAs and Quarterly Performance Check-ins, utilizing the resulting data to drive targeted Learning & Development (L&D) planning.
- **Organizational Development & Clarity:** Managed Role Dimensioning and collaborated on creating defined Role-wise Career Paths to enhance organizational structure and support talent retention strategies.
- **Strategic Project Management and Employee Benefits:** Managed and executed complex, company-wide HR initiatives and deep-dive projects, including the **"Great Place to Work"** certification process, **Employee Pulse Surveys**, and **Focus Group Discussions (FGDs)**, to actively shape culture and retention strategies. Organize companywide employee engagement events across all company locations in India.

Manager – HR (Regional Head – HR)

Bigbasket (Innovative Retail Concepts Pvt Ltd) | 10/2018 - 09/2021 | Delhi /NCR

- **Scale and Setup:** Led HR setup and scaling for the Delhi NCR region from 0 to 45+ hubs, working directly with Business, Sales, and Operations Heads to define manpower needs.
- **High-Volume Hiring:** Directed the rapid hiring and onboarding of 1000+ personnel within 06 months, establishing foundational HR systems.
- **Cost Savings:** Executed a strategic Opex reduction initiative by tracking per order delivery cost and restructuring the last-mile delivery model (e.g., part-time partners, third-party E-Rickshaw integration).
- **Operational Achievement:** Achieved a substantial reduction in per order delivery cost from approximately **Rs. 7.5 to Rs. 3.5-4** through strategic model changes and performance alignment.
- **Incentive Program:** Revamped compensation by shifting from fixed monthly pay to performance-based incentives for delivery partners, significantly boosting morale and driving higher productivity.

Senior Manager – HR (Zonal Head – HR)

SastaSundar Healthbuddy Ltd (Flipkart Health) | 08/2017 - 09/2018

- **Building structural Foundation:** Framed HR policies and operational workflows aligned with leadership vision, facilitating a smooth regional launch.
- Conducted Competency Mapping and resolved employee queries, arranging necessary HR interventions.
- Guided performance processes and rewards management for the zonal team.
- **Talent Development:** Implemented competency mapping exercises and tailored Learning and Development (L&D) interventions for field and central staff.

Deputy Manager – HR

Bigbasket (Supermarket Groceries Supplies Pvt Ltd) | 02/2016 - 08/2017 | Delhi, North India

- Led hiring efforts and managed the manpower budget for a new regional setup.
- Established and implemented comprehensive HR systems, including policy framing, for smooth operations in the North Zone.
- Managed the acquisition of HR-related licenses and ensured statutory compliance across the region.
- Delivered Performance Management System (PMS) workshops, covering goal setting and appraisals, and conducted periodic HR process audits.
- Managed vendors and ensured accurate and timely payroll inputs.

Senior Executive – HR (Cluster Manager- HR)

Big Bazaar (Future Retail Ltd) | 01/2011 - 02/2016 | Jaipur

- **Recruitment:** Handled high-volume, bulk recruitment strategies to staff all new store openings in Rajasthan and manage consistent attrition/replacement needs across the cluster.
- **Engagement:** Directed comprehensive Employee Engagement and Wellness programs, including managing employee benefits and serving as the primary advisor on people issues.
- **HR Management:** Managed the complete employee lifecycle, ensuring strict adherence to HR policies and procedures, and ensured the timely closure of the Performance Management System (PMS).
- **Compliance/Audit:** Conducted regular HR compliance and process audits for all Rajasthan stores, ensuring smooth operations during new store openings and the rationalization/closure of non-performing stores.

Assistant Manager - HR (Plant - HR)

Reliance Power Ltd | 06/2008 - 09/2010 | Shahjahanpur

- Supported the implementation of corporate HR strategies, managing end-to-end HR operations, manpower planning, recruitment, and employee relations.
- Maintained strict statutory compliance with labor laws, assisted in government relations, and managed comprehensive payroll administration and employee benefits processing.
- Administered critical employee welfare initiatives, including the provisioning of free hostel accommodations, subsidized meals, and vehicle access.
- Managed township infrastructure, external vendor relations, and the procurement of administrative supplies and services for the plant site.

EDUCATION

- **Post Graduate Diploma in Business Management** Accman Institute of Management - Greater Noida 2006-08
- **B.Sc. (Information Technology)** Sikkim Manipal University, Kota 2003-06

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Handled Multiple Projects Viz – **Great Place to Work.**
- Implementation of New HRMS System
- Multiple Awards for Team working and projects
- Managing Central Projects and engagement initiatives.

PERSONAL DETAILS

Date of Birth: 06th June, 1985
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